The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire"

Āryavajrājitānalapramohanī nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 954 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ཇི་ཕེམ་པ་མ་ལེན་རྣ་རབ་ཏུ་རྨོངས་བྱེད་ཅེས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Vajra Ajita Anala Pramohanī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Dorjé Mipampa Mé Tar Rabtu Mongjé Chéjawé Zung, is a dhāraṇī scripture, a text centered on a sacred incantation believed to offer protection and spiritual power. It opens in the traditional manner of a sūtra, with homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas and the words "Thus did I hear at one time." It then describes the Blessed One dwelling on a supreme mountain among snowy valleys, a place resplendent with golden stone, rainbow light from countless jewels, fragrant flowers, incense, and parasols, which sets the scene for the teaching of the dhāraṇī. The text is Toh 954 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations and spells preserved within the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: ārya vajra ajita anala pramohanī nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling on the supreme mountain, a mountain with multi-storied houses topped by jewel peaks, the finest of the snowy mountain valleys. Like the lower slopes and the waist of Mount Meru, it was filled with many kinds of golden stone, blazing as if inlaid. It had broad stone slabs from which the many lights of countless precious stones arose like rainbows. Fragrant flowers were strewn about, and its caves and forests were perfumed with powders and many fragrant incenses. It was beautified with parasols, aloeswood, powders, bells, and canopies.

Then, around the Blessed One, there assembled vast, all-pervading hosts that formed a circle of retinue five hundred yojanas wide: gods, sons of gods, asuras, Vāyu gods of the wind, sons of the Vāyu gods, garuḍas, nāgas, yakṣas, kinnaras, rākṣasas, gandharvas, accomplished vidyādharas, bhūtas, vināyakas, piśācas, and hosts of visible and invisible mātṛkās, the "mother" goddesses. He was also together with seventy-five thousand bodhisattvas who

dwelt there and twelve thousand five hundred monks.

The Blessed One was teaching the Dharma. He taught a Dharma that is pleasant to abide in, pleasant to hear, and that leads to deliverance from saṃsāra.

Then the gods, the sons of gods, the asuras, the sons of asuras, the Vāyu gods, the sons of the Vāyu gods, the garuḍas, the nāgas, the yakṣas, the kinnaras, the rākṣasas, the sons of rākṣasas, the gandharvas, the accomplished vidyādharas, the bhūtas, the vināyakas, the piśācas, the hosts of visible and invisible mātṛkās, and the hosts of bhūtas, all these hosts of spirits, roamed about and uttered cries of clamor, fear, and distress.

When the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni heard those cries, he spoke these words: "O noble sirs, why do you utter cries of clamor, fear, distress, and turmoil?"

They replied, "Blessed One, we have been brought under another's power. Harmed and dragged, we are summoned and hauled off, and we are being menaced. Blessed One, please protect us!"

When they had said this, merely through the Blessed One's bringing him to mind, there came the bodhisattva, the great being, endowed with the supreme intelligence, understanding, action, and culmination of action that reveal the vast maṇḍala above all others; who, from the great ground, had attained a further ground and was close to regency, empowered into the kingdom of the Dharma. His shoulders were broad as a vajra vessel. He wore a crown hard as vajra, glittering with rays of light, and vajra armlets. His body was hard and firm. He held in his hands a vajra, a noose, and steadfast, blazing weapons, and he utterly crushed with a hard vajra dagger. He had great might and a following of four hundred fifty thousand attendants, and he illuminated this entire world system.

Together with Vajrakumāra of the vajra family, Vajrasena, Vajradaṇḍa, Vajragarbha, Vajraketu, Vajrāloka, Nīlavajra, Ratnavajra, Guhyavajra, Cakravajra, and others; with the great vajra generals, the army protectors, the land protectors, the vajra vidyā kings who fully understand what is real and what is unreal, the vajra mothers, and the vajra vināyakas, he roused and stirred up the vajra-youth grahas, the vajra oppressors, and the vajra bringers of bad dreams. He illuminated all who were gathered in the great courtyard of the assembly, fully illuminated them, made them clear, made them fully clear, made them overjoyed, roused them, and stirred each of them. He then went to

where the Blessed One was, removed his upper robe, touched his crown to the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated him three times, joined his palms, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One expressed his approval and said, "Vajradhara, go and fulfill the wishes of the gods, the sons of gods, the asuras, the sons of asuras, the Vāyu gods, the sons of the Vāyu gods, the garuḍas, the sons of garuḍas, and all the rest, up to the great assembly, who are crying out and suffering distress!"

Then Vajradhara rose from his seat and went among the hosts of gods, asuras, Vāyu gods, garuḍas, and bhūtas. Instructing them, he entered into the meditative absorption called Fire Lamp of the Vajra Weapon. Through his miraculous power, throughout the great trichiliocosm, with light radiating from blazing flames, with showers of scattering sparks, and with lightning that struck down in tongues of fire, he tormented the world systems.

Then, over five great eons, through dreams and water, in measures equal to the number of grains of sand in the river Ganges, the vajra accomplished through deeds arising from radiance, splendor, celibacy, purity, patience, moral discipline, vows, austerity, and all one's own enjoyments was placed into the hand of that bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi.

That vajra became the teaching of the Dharma of the scriptures of the buddhas, the blessed ones. It brings about the Dharma, the moral discipline and the meditative absorption of the arhats, and the perfections, the moral discipline, the patience and the compassion of the bodhisattvas. It became one's own vajra, the knowledge-mantra of the family, the maṇḍala, and the mode of recitation. It tames those hard to tame: Rudra, Indra (Śakra), Yama, Varuṇa, Kubera, Vāyu, and the garuḍas.

Thus the blessed fierce wrathful ones who arise from it bewilder the fierce, stupefy the deceitful, drive off the hateful, destroy the deluded, uproot the entrenched, crush the swollen to dust, straighten the crooked, turn those who cut down toward compassion, terrify the bhūtas, frighten the rākṣasas, bring one's own secret mantras to completion, and pin down others' secret mantras with the ritual dagger. They reveal what has declined. They are those who cause killing, who kill, who harm and who ruin. Having gone there, they bring the gods and the sons of the gods under control. In this way the followers of Rudra attain Rudra, the followers of Viṣṇu attain Viṣṇu, and the followers of the asuras attain the asura state. They urge all of these on and lead them into the

maṇḍala. They set them in motion, display their power, make them forget, and fill them with terror.

Vajradhara, who taught with the intent of the ten powers, spoke the dhāraṇī called Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire. Through the power of this dhāraṇī and the blessing of truth, rays arising from the great maṇḍala of rays of light roused Vajrapāṇi together with his vajra. Overjoyed at that light, with the radiance spreading from the vajra he outshone the autumn stars and the moonlight of the three worlds and made everything a single illumination. He dried up the great ocean and shook Mount Meru, king of mountains. He sounded wheels of lightning and thunder that hurled down tongues of fire, sent forth a fierce roar, proclaimed a mighty resounding sound, and struck terror.

Then the dhāraṇī called Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire, that blessed lady called Vajra Daughter, holder of the vajra, abiding within great radiating tongues of flame, her mass of hair like gold and jewels, circled three times. With a force swifter than the mind, radiating light and blazing, she fiercely went for refuge to the bodhisattva, the great being of great miraculous power.

When she had come, noble Vajradhara said, "Greatly fortunate virtuous lady, endowed with the mind of the Tathāgata's meditative absorption, grant these the power to accord with their implements!"

Then the dhāraṇī said, "I shall do these things just as you have commanded," and she spoke these words three times.

"O Lady of Three Topknots! Purify the three worlds, the three times, the trident of Rudra, the discus of Viṣṇu, the club of Yama, the staff of Kubera, the vajra of Indra, the noose of Varuṇa, the obstructions of the vināyakas, the illusions of the asuras, the splendor of the Vāyu gods, the bewilderment of force and of the siddhas, the cutting of the hosts of mātṛkās, the samaya of the nāgas, poison, the wrathful ones, the yakṣas, the rākṣasas, the kinnaras, the piśācas, the bhūtas, the brahmarākṣasas, the kumbhāṇḍas, the nairṛtas, the oppressors, and those who attack when the vetālas strike, and likewise all others!"

In merely the blink of an eye, in an instant, she made offerings to all, then offered this heart mantra to Vajrapāṇi, saying:

Homage to the Three Jewels! Homage to the great yakṣa general, fierce Vajrapāṇi!

tadyathā tathāgata samādhi dhāraṇī mahā avarta yiṣyāmi ahi vajre kuṭili koṭi pāvakā kula śikhi kavila keśi taṭi ciṭa ciṭi maṭani karkaṭa muṭi vaṭṭi vajre mahā vidhullo lole pagu pulu sumu sumu sara sara sphaṭa sphaṭa sudyote piṃgale ciṭe vicaṭi jrala vigale sarva devagna praharaṇa māyā siddha dāyige suruke suruke vajra ghoṇe vajra ḍḍhi sāra praharaṇe ratṇa traya dikrala buddhe te vajradhara viśvasanika apratihata pramardani svāhā

Whoever remembers this secret mantra and recites it, meditates on it, or holds it, and even one who hears it, will not fall wrongly into the lower destinies. It will be as though they had made offerings to all the maṇḍalas, mundane and supramundane. They will have entered the samaya and the mudrā. By intention and by rejoicing they summon. They strike terror by means of poison, secret mantras, knots, beating, the fear of binding and the like.

Then, through its power, those gods and sons of gods experienced the display of the Blessed Vajradhara and the many and various teachings spoken by the Blessed One. Those dwelling in the Pure Abodes above, the gods of Akaniṣṭha, and those dwelling in other world systems made offerings with luminous flowers, clouds of incense, and a vast rain of many jewels. They praised with melodious praises, and also spoke verses that were melodious and deep like the sound of a drum, cooling, and full of merit.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and that entire assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble dhāraṇī called Invincible Vajra Who Utterly Bewilders Like Fire.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé, and was further revised and finalized according to the new terminology.

Translator's Notes

• The simile for the shoulders, literally "like a vajra zom," is uncertain. Zom ordinarily means a large vessel or pail, and "vajra vessel" is a tentative rendering. In the passage on the spirits' cries, the Tibetan repeats "the hosts of bhūtas" at the end of the list, probably by dittography. Since the Buddha then addresses all of them, the whole list is taken as the subject of the roaming and crying. The final sentence is grammatically loose in the Tibetan. The giver of the vajra is not named, so a passive is used, and the role of "dreams and water" and of the Ganges-sand measure is unclear; it is translated as it stands. The names in the list of vajra

deities are reconstructed from standard Tibetan equivalents (for example, Vajrāloka for "vajra light" and Nīlavajra for "blue vajra"). These are reasonable but not attested with certainty for this text.
• The passage beginning "O Lady of Three Topknots" does not name its speaker. It reads most naturally as Vajradhara's command to the dhāraṇī goddess, which she then carries out. The term rendered "oppressors" may name a class of spirits that cannot be securely identified. The phrase rendered "make them forget" could also be read as "make them find."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.